

ECE 332 — Homework 3: Generated Answers from Final Cheat Sheet

Each solution shows the cheat sheet snippet used, then the answer.

Symbol reference (used throughout):

- $\epsilon_0 = 8.854 \times 10^{-12}$ F/m — permittivity of free space (constant)
- $\mu_0 = 4\pi \times 10^{-7}$ H/m — permeability of free space (constant)
- ϵ_r — relative permittivity (dielectric constant) of the medium, dimensionless
- μ_r — relative permeability of the medium, dimensionless. $\mu_r = 1$ for nonmagnetic materials (air, most dielectrics)
- $\epsilon = \epsilon_r \epsilon_0$ — absolute permittivity of the medium (F/m)
- $\mu = \mu_r \mu_0$ — absolute permeability of the medium (H/m)
- σ — conductivity of the medium (S/m). $\sigma = 0$ for lossless / ideal dielectric
- $\eta = \sqrt{\mu/\epsilon}$ — intrinsic impedance of the medium (Ω)
- $\eta_0 = \sqrt{\mu_0/\epsilon_0} = 120\pi \approx 377\Omega$ — intrinsic impedance of free space
- $k = \omega\sqrt{\mu\epsilon} = \omega\sqrt{\epsilon_r}/c$ (nonmag.) — wavenumber (rad/m)
- α — attenuation constant (Np/m); β — phase constant (rad/m)
- $\Gamma = (\eta_2 - \eta_1)/(\eta_2 + \eta_1)$ — reflection coefficient (unitless)
- $\tau = 1 + \Gamma$ — transmission coefficient (unitless)
- Superscripts on $\tilde{\mathbf{E}}$: i = incident, r = reflected, t = transmitted. Three distinct waves, three distinct superscripts.

***Note:** the official HW3 solution PDF labels both reflected and transmitted as $\tilde{E}^r$ (typo). The second one is really $\tilde{E}^t$ — you can tell because it carries τ and k_2 instead of Γ and k_1 . This doc uses the correct $i/r/t$ throughout.*

Problem 1 — LHC Wave Normally Incident on a Dielectric

20 pts

Setup: 200 MHz LHC plane wave in air, $|E| = 5$ V/m, normally incident on dielectric ($\epsilon_r = 4$) at $z \geq 0$. Positive max at $z = 0$, $t = 0$.

NORMAL INCIDENCE — Γ AND τ

Med. 1 ($z < 0$): incident side. **Med. 2** ($z \geq 0$): transmitted side. Boundary at $z = 0$.

Reflection coeff. *wave from medium 1*

$$\Gamma = \frac{\eta_2 - \eta_1}{\eta_2 + \eta_1} \text{ (unitless)}$$

Transmission coeff. *always*

$$\tau = 1 + \Gamma = \frac{2\eta_2}{\eta_2 + \eta_1}$$

Intrinsic impedance *general $\rightarrow$ nonmag. shortcut*

$$\eta_i = \sqrt{\frac{\mu_r}{\epsilon_r}} \eta_0 \xrightarrow{\mu_r=1} \frac{\eta_0}{\sqrt{\epsilon_{r,i}}} \text{ (}\Omega\text{)} \quad \eta_0 = 120\pi \approx 377 \Omega$$

Default $\mu_r = 1$ (air, dielectric, “nonmag.”). Only use $\mu_r \neq 1$ if problem says so (“ferromagnetic”, iron, ferrite, or μ_r given explicitly).

Low-loss η_2 (poor conductor) $\sigma/(\omega\epsilon) \ll 1$

$$\eta_2 \approx \sqrt{\frac{\mu}{\epsilon'}} \left(1 + j \frac{\sigma}{2\omega\epsilon'}\right) \xrightarrow{\text{drop tiny } j} \frac{\eta_0}{\sqrt{\epsilon_{r,2}}} \text{ (}\Omega\text{)}$$

For Γ/τ just use $\eta_0/\sqrt{\epsilon_{r,2}}$. The j term is for accuracy with $|\eta_c|, \theta_\eta$.

POWER REFLECTION & TRANSMISSION

% reflected *always*

$$\%P_r = 100 |\Gamma|^2$$

% transmitted *η -ratio matters!*

$$\%P_t = 100 |\tau|^2 \frac{\eta_1}{\eta_2}$$

Check: $\%P_r + \%P_t = 100$.

If medium 2 is denser ($\eta_2 < \eta_1$), $|\tau| > 1$ but $\%P_t < 100\%$ because of the η_1/η_2 factor.

 $\tilde{\mathbf{E}}$ PHASOR TEMPLATES

Wavenumber per medium *nonmag.*

$$k_i = \frac{\omega\sqrt{\epsilon_{r,i}}}{c} \text{ (rad/m)} \Rightarrow k_2 = k_1 \sqrt{\epsilon_{r,2}/\epsilon_{r,1}}$$

Direction table $u \in \{x, y, z\} = \text{axis perp. to boundary}$

Inc dir	Inc	Refl	Trans
$+\hat{u}$	$e^{-jk_1 u}$	$e^{+jk_1 u}$	$e^{-jk_2 u}$
$-\hat{u}$	$e^{+jk_1 u}$	$e^{-jk_1 u}$	$e^{+jk_2 u}$

$+\hat{u}$ direction $\Leftrightarrow$ Med 2 at $u \geq 0$. Reflected sign flips, transmitted matches incident.

General template (incident has pol. $\hat{e}$, amplitude a_0):

$$\tilde{\mathbf{E}}^i = a_0 \hat{e} e^{\mp j k_1 u}, \quad \tilde{\mathbf{E}}^r = \Gamma a_0 \hat{e} e^{\pm j k_1 u}, \quad \tilde{\mathbf{E}}^t = \tau a_0 \hat{e} e^{\mp j k_2 u}$$

(lossy med 2: replace $e^{\mp j k_2 u}$ with $e^{\mp \alpha_2 u} e^{\mp j \beta_2 u}$)

Total in medium 1: $\tilde{\mathbf{E}}_1 = \tilde{\mathbf{E}}^i + \tilde{\mathbf{E}}^r$.

$\hat{e}$ by polarization *plug into templates above*

Pol.	$\hat{e}$	Note
Lin. $\hat{x}$	$\hat{x}$	$E_y = 0$
Lin. $\hat{y}$	$\hat{y}$	$E_x = 0$
Lin. at 45°	$(\hat{x} + \hat{y})/\sqrt{2}$	in phase
RHC	$\hat{x} - j\hat{y}$	$\delta = -\pi/2$
LHC	$\hat{x} + j\hat{y}$	$\delta = +\pi/2$
General	$a_x \hat{x} + a_y e^{j\delta} \hat{y}$	elliptical

Γ, τ act on $\hat{e}$ unchanged. Only swap the polarization, not the formulas.

Wave parameters in medium 1 (air):

Angular frequency from f :

$$\omega = 2\pi f = 2\pi(2 \times 10^8) = 4\pi \times 10^8 \text{ rad/s}$$

Wavenumber from the lossless plane wave formula $k = \omega\sqrt{\epsilon_r}/c$. In air, $\epsilon_r = 1$ so this reduces to $k_1 = \omega/c$:

$$k_1 = \frac{\omega}{c} = \frac{4\pi \times 10^8}{3 \times 10^8} = \frac{4\pi}{3} \text{ rad/m}$$

(a) **LHC incident phasor.** The PHASOR TEMPLATES section says the incident wave has the form $\tilde{\mathbf{E}}^i = a_0 \hat{e} e^{-jk_1 z}$ where $\hat{e}$ depends on polarization. From the polarization table:

$$\text{LHC} \Rightarrow \hat{e} = \hat{x} + j\hat{y}$$

With $a_0 = 5 \text{ V/m}$ (the modulus) and $k_1 = 4\pi/3$:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{E}}^i = 5(\hat{x} + j\hat{y}) e^{-j4\pi z/3} \text{ V/m}$$

(b) **Reflection coefficient Γ and transmission coefficient τ .**

General intrinsic impedance: $\eta = \sqrt{\mu/\epsilon}$.

Decompose into relative + free-space constants: since $\mu = \mu_r \mu_0$ and $\varepsilon = \varepsilon_r \varepsilon_0$,

$$\eta = \sqrt{\frac{\mu_r \mu_0}{\varepsilon_r \varepsilon_0}} = \sqrt{\frac{\mu_r}{\varepsilon_r}} \cdot \sqrt{\frac{\mu_0}{\varepsilon_0}} = \sqrt{\frac{\mu_r}{\varepsilon_r}} \eta_0$$

which for nonmagnetic media ($\mu_r = 1$) reduces to $\eta = \eta_0 / \sqrt{\varepsilon_r}$.

Compute η_0 from μ_0, ε_0 directly:

$$\eta_0 = \sqrt{\frac{\mu_0}{\varepsilon_0}} = \sqrt{(4\pi \times 10^{-7})(36\pi \times 10^9)} = 120\pi \Omega \approx 377 \Omega$$

Medium 1 (air): $\mu_r = 1, \varepsilon_r = 1$. So $\eta_1 = \eta_0 \sqrt{1/1} = \eta_0 = 120\pi \Omega$.

Medium 2 (nonmagnetic dielectric, $\mu_r = 1, \varepsilon_r = 4$): use the shortcut $\eta = \eta_0 / \sqrt{\varepsilon_r}$:

$$\eta_2 = \frac{\eta_0}{\sqrt{\varepsilon_{r2}}} = \frac{120\pi}{\sqrt{4}} = \frac{120\pi}{2} = 60\pi \Omega$$

Now apply the boundary formula $\Gamma = (\eta_2 - \eta_1) / (\eta_2 + \eta_1)$:

$$\Gamma = \frac{60\pi - 120\pi}{60\pi + 120\pi} = \frac{-60\pi}{180\pi} = \boxed{-\frac{1}{3}}$$

$$\tau = 1 + \Gamma = 1 - \frac{1}{3} = \boxed{\frac{2}{3}}$$

(c) Reflected, transmitted, and total field phasors.

Wavenumbers in both media use the same formula $k_i = \omega \sqrt{\varepsilon_{r,i}} / c$, just plug in each medium's ε_r :

Medium 1 (air, $\varepsilon_{r,1} = 1$):

$$k_1 = \frac{\omega \sqrt{1}}{c} = \frac{4\pi \times 10^8}{3 \times 10^8} = \frac{4\pi}{3} \text{ rad/m}$$

Medium 2 (dielectric, $\varepsilon_{r,2} = 4$):

$$k_2 = \frac{\omega \sqrt{4}}{c} = \frac{2\omega}{c} = 2k_1 = \frac{8\pi}{3} \text{ rad/m}$$

Notice: same formula, only ε_r changes per medium (just like η).

From the PHASOR TEMPLATES (reflected wave travels in $-\hat{z}$, sign of z -term flips):

$$\tilde{\mathbf{E}}^r = \Gamma \cdot a_0 \hat{e}^{+jk_1 z} = -\frac{1}{3} \cdot 5(\hat{x} + j\hat{y}) e^{+j4\pi z/3} = -\frac{5}{3}(\hat{x} + j\hat{y}) e^{+j4\pi z/3}$$

Transmitted wave in lossless medium 2:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{E}}^t = \tau \cdot a_0 \hat{e}^{-jk_2 z} = \frac{2}{3} \cdot 5(\hat{x} + j\hat{y}) e^{-j8\pi z/3} = \frac{10}{3}(\hat{x} + j\hat{y}) e^{-j8\pi z/3}$$

Total field in medium 1 is incident + reflected:

$$\boxed{\tilde{\mathbf{E}}_1 = \tilde{\mathbf{E}}^i + \tilde{\mathbf{E}}^r = 5(\hat{x} + j\hat{y}) \left(e^{-j4\pi z/3} - \frac{1}{3} e^{+j4\pi z/3} \right) \text{ V/m}}$$

(d) Percentages of incident average power reflected and transmitted.

From the POWER REFLECTION snippet, $\%P_r = 100|\Gamma|^2$ and $\%P_t = 100|\tau|^2(\eta_1/\eta_2)$. The η_1/η_2 factor accounts for the change in wave impedance: even though $|\tau| > 0$, the medium beyond carries power differently.

$$\%P_r = 100 \cdot \left| -\frac{1}{3} \right|^2 = 100 \cdot \frac{1}{9} = \boxed{11.1\%}$$

$$\%P_t = 100 \cdot \left| \frac{2}{3} \right|^2 \cdot \frac{120\pi}{60\pi} = 100 \cdot \frac{4}{9} \cdot 2 = \boxed{88.9\%}$$

Sanity check: $11.1\% + 88.9\% = 100\%$. Energy conserved.

Problem 2 — Same Wave, Poor-Conductor Medium 2

20 pts

Setup: Replace medium 2 with poor conductor: $\epsilon_r = 2.25$, $\mu_r = 1$, $\sigma = 10^{-4}$ S/m. Everything else same as P1.

NORMAL INCIDENCE — Γ AND τ

Med. 1 ($z < 0$): incident side. **Med. 2** ($z \geq 0$): transmitted side. Boundary at $z = 0$.

Reflection coeff. *wave from medium 1*

$$\Gamma = \frac{\eta_2 - \eta_1}{\eta_2 + \eta_1} \text{ (unitless)}$$

Transmission coeff. *always*

$$\tau = 1 + \Gamma = \frac{2\eta_2}{\eta_2 + \eta_1}$$

Intrinsic impedance *general $\rightarrow$ nonmag. shortcut*

$$\eta_i = \sqrt{\frac{\mu_r}{\epsilon_r}} \eta_0 \xrightarrow{\mu_r=1} \frac{\eta_0}{\sqrt{\epsilon_{r,i}}} \text{ (}\Omega\text{)} \quad \eta_0 = 120\pi \approx 377 \Omega$$

Default $\mu_r = 1$ (air, dielectric, “nonmag.”). Only use $\mu_r \neq 1$ if problem says so (“ferromagnetic”, iron, ferrite, or μ_r given explicitly).

Low-loss η_2 (poor conductor) $\sigma/(\omega\epsilon) \ll 1$

$$\eta_2 \approx \sqrt{\frac{\mu}{\epsilon}} \left(1 + j \frac{\sigma}{2\omega\epsilon}\right) \xrightarrow{\text{drop tiny } j} \frac{\eta_0}{\sqrt{\epsilon_{r,2}}} \text{ (}\Omega\text{)}$$

For Γ/τ just use $\eta_0/\sqrt{\epsilon_{r,2}}$. The j term is for accuracy with $|\eta_c|, \theta_\eta$.

LOSSY MEDIA — 5 CASES

Loss tangent $\epsilon' = \epsilon_r \epsilon_0$, $\epsilon_0 \approx 1/(36\pi \times 10^9)$

$$\frac{\epsilon''}{\epsilon'} = \frac{\sigma}{\omega\epsilon_r\epsilon_0}$$

Type	$\sigma/\omega\epsilon$	η_c, α, β
Lossless	0	$\eta = \eta_0/\sqrt{\epsilon_r}$ exact; $\alpha = 0, \beta = (\sigma=0)$
Low-loss	$< 10^{-2}$	$\eta_c \approx \frac{\eta_0}{\sqrt{\epsilon_r}} \left(1 + j \frac{\sigma}{2\omega\epsilon}\right)$; $\alpha \approx \frac{\sigma\eta_0}{2\sqrt{\epsilon_r}}$, $\beta \approx \frac{\omega\sqrt{\epsilon_r}}{c}$
Quasi-cond.	$10^{-2} - 10^2$	exact: $(\eta/\sqrt{X})e^{j\theta_\eta}$, see below
Good cond.	$> 10^2$	$\eta_c \approx (1+j)\sqrt{\pi f \mu/\sigma}$; $\alpha \approx \beta \approx \sqrt{\pi f \mu \sigma}$
Magnetic	any	keep full $\sqrt{\mu_r/\epsilon_r} \eta_0$

For Γ/τ : drop j correction; use $\eta_0/\sqrt{\epsilon_r}$. Magnetic: keep μ_r .

Exact (quasi-cond) $X = \sqrt{1 + (\epsilon''/\epsilon')^2}$

$$\alpha = \omega\sqrt{\frac{\mu\epsilon'}{2}}\sqrt{X-1}, \quad \beta = \omega\sqrt{\frac{\mu\epsilon'}{2}}\sqrt{X+1}, \quad \theta_\eta = \frac{1}{2} \arctan \frac{\epsilon''}{\epsilon'}$$

 $\hat{\mathbf{E}}$ PHASOR TEMPLATES

Wavenumber per medium *nonmag.*

$$k_i = \frac{\omega\sqrt{\epsilon_{r,i}}}{c} \text{ (rad/m)} \Rightarrow k_2 = k_1\sqrt{\epsilon_{r,2}/\epsilon_{r,1}}$$

Direction table $u \in \{x, y, z\}$ = axis perp. to boundary

Inc dir	Inc	Refl	Trans
$+\hat{u}$	$e^{-jk_1 u}$	$e^{+jk_1 u}$	$e^{-jk_2 u}$
$-\hat{u}$	$e^{+jk_1 u}$	$e^{-jk_1 u}$	$e^{+jk_2 u}$

$+\hat{u}$ direction $\Leftrightarrow$ Med 2 at $u \geq 0$. Reflected sign flips, transmitted matches incident.

General template (incident has pol. $\hat{e}$, amplitude a_0):

$$\hat{\mathbf{E}}^i = a_0 \hat{e} e^{\mp jk_1 u}, \quad \hat{\mathbf{E}}^r = \Gamma a_0 \hat{e} e^{\pm jk_1 u}, \quad \hat{\mathbf{E}}^t = \tau a_0 \hat{e} e^{\mp jk_2 u}$$

(lossy med 2: replace $e^{\mp jk_2 u}$ with $e^{\mp \alpha_2 u} e^{\mp j\beta_2 u}$)

Total in medium 1: $\hat{\mathbf{E}}_1 = \hat{\mathbf{E}}^i + \hat{\mathbf{E}}^r$.

$\hat{e}$ by polarization *plug into templates above*

Pol.	$\hat{e}$	Note
Lin. $\hat{x}$	$\hat{x}$	$E_y = 0$
Lin. $\hat{y}$	$\hat{y}$	$E_x = 0$
Lin. at 45°	$(\hat{x} + \hat{y})/\sqrt{2}$	in phase
RHC	$\hat{x} - j\hat{y}$	$\delta = -\pi/2$
LHC	$\hat{x} + j\hat{y}$	$\delta = +\pi/2$
General	$a_x \hat{x} + a_y e^{j\delta} \hat{y}$	elliptical

Γ, τ act on $\hat{e}$ unchanged. Only swap the polarization, not the formulas.

POWER REFLECTION & TRANSMISSION

% reflected *always*

$$\%P_r = 100 |\Gamma|^2$$

% transmitted *η -ratio matters!*

$$\%P_t = 100 |\tau|^2 \frac{\eta_1}{\eta_2}$$

Check: $\%P_r + \%P_t = 100$.

If medium 2 is denser ($\eta_2 < \eta_1$), $|\tau| > 1$ but $\%P_t < 100\%$ because of the η_1/η_2 factor.

Wave parameters in medium 1 (air). Same as P1, since medium 1 hasn't changed:

$$\omega = 2\pi f = 4\pi \times 10^8 \text{ rad/s}, \quad k_1 = \frac{\omega\sqrt{\epsilon_{r,1}}}{c} = \frac{\omega}{c} = \frac{4\pi}{3} \text{ rad/m}, \quad \eta_1 = \eta_0 = 120\pi \Omega$$

(a) **LHC incident phasor.** Identical to P1 — incident wave is in medium 1 (air), which didn't change. From the PHASOR TEMPLATES + polarization table ($\hat{e}_{\text{LHC}} = \hat{x} + j\hat{y}$):

$$\hat{\mathbf{E}}^i = 5(\hat{x} + j\hat{y}) e^{-j4\pi z/3} \text{ V/m}$$

(b) Reflection and transmission coefficients — but first classify medium 2.

Compute the loss tangent $\sigma/(\omega\epsilon)$ to pick which formulas to use:

$$\frac{\sigma_2}{\omega\epsilon_2} = \frac{\sigma_2}{\omega\epsilon_{r,2}\epsilon_0} = \frac{10^{-4}}{(4\pi \times 10^8)(2.25)(8.854 \times 10^{-12})} = 4 \times 10^{-3}$$

This is $\ll 1$, so medium 2 is a **low-loss dielectric**. The LOSSY MEDIA — CLASSIFICATION table tells us to use the LOW-LOSS QUICK PARAMS shortcuts (not the full exact lossy formulas).

Intrinsic impedance — same derivation chain as P1, with the low-loss correction. From the cheat sheet's NORMAL INCIDENCE ebox the general formula is $\eta = \sqrt{\mu_r/\epsilon_r} \eta_0$. For low-loss media the LOW-LOSS QUICK PARAMS box says:

$$\eta_2 \approx \sqrt{\frac{\mu}{\epsilon'}} (1 + j \frac{\sigma}{2\omega\epsilon'}) \xrightarrow{\frac{\mu_r=1}{\sigma/\omega\epsilon \ll 1}} \frac{\eta_0}{\sqrt{\epsilon_r}}$$

The j correction is $4 \times 10^{-3}/2 = 2 \times 10^{-3}$, tiny enough to drop for Γ, τ computation. So:

$$\eta_2 \approx \frac{\eta_0}{\sqrt{\epsilon_{r,2}}} = \frac{120\pi}{\sqrt{2.25}} = \frac{120\pi}{1.5} = 80\pi \Omega$$

Attenuation and phase constants from LOW-LOSS QUICK PARAMS (these matter for the transmitted-wave decay even though they don't affect Γ):

$$\alpha_2 \approx \frac{\sigma_2 \eta_0}{2\sqrt{\epsilon_{r,2}}} = \frac{10^{-4} \cdot 120\pi}{2\sqrt{2.25}} = 1.26 \times 10^{-2} \text{ Np/m}$$

$$\beta_2 \approx \frac{\omega\sqrt{\epsilon_{r,2}}}{c} = \frac{(4\pi \times 10^8)(1.5)}{3 \times 10^8} = 2\pi \text{ rad/m}$$

Apply the boundary formulas:

$$\Gamma = \frac{\eta_2 - \eta_1}{\eta_2 + \eta_1} = \frac{80\pi - 120\pi}{80\pi + 120\pi} = \frac{-40\pi}{200\pi} = \boxed{-\frac{1}{5}}$$

$$\tau = 1 + \Gamma = 1 - \frac{1}{5} = \boxed{\frac{4}{5}}$$

(c) Reflected, transmitted, and total field phasors.

Direction signs from the DIRECTION TABLE. Med 2 is at $z \geq 0$ (same as P1), so use the first row: incident gets $-jk_1 z$, reflected gets $+jk_1 z$, transmitted gets the lossy decay $e^{-\alpha_2 z} e^{-j\beta_2 z}$ (since med 2 is now lossy, replace $e^{-jk_2 z}$ with $e^{-\alpha_2 z} e^{-j\beta_2 z}$).

Reflected template (still in lossless medium 1, traveling $-\hat{z}$):

$$\tilde{\mathbf{E}}^r = \Gamma a_0 \hat{e} e^{+jk_1 z}$$

Plug in $\Gamma = -1/5$, $a_0 = 5$, $\hat{e} = \hat{x} + j\hat{y}$, $k_1 = 4\pi/3$:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{E}}^r = -\frac{1}{5} \cdot 5(\hat{x} + j\hat{y}) e^{+j4\pi z/3} = -(\hat{x} + j\hat{y}) e^{+j4\pi z/3} \text{ V/m}$$

Transmitted template (lossy medium 2, traveling $+\hat{z}$, replace $e^{-jk_2 z}$ with $e^{-\alpha_2 z} e^{-j\beta_2 z}$):

$$\tilde{\mathbf{E}}^t = \tau a_0 \hat{e} e^{-\alpha_2 z} e^{-j\beta_2 z}$$

Plug in $\tau = 4/5$, $a_0 = 5$, $\hat{e} = \hat{x} + j\hat{y}$, $\alpha_2 = 1.26 \times 10^{-2}$, $\beta_2 = 2\pi$:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{E}}^t = \frac{4}{5} \cdot 5(\hat{x} + j\hat{y}) e^{-\alpha_2 z} e^{-j\beta_2 z} = 4(\hat{x} + j\hat{y}) e^{-1.26 \times 10^{-2} z} e^{-j2\pi z} \text{ V/m}$$

Total field in medium 1 ($z \leq 0$):

$$\tilde{\mathbf{E}}_1 = \tilde{\mathbf{E}}^i + \tilde{\mathbf{E}}^r = 5(\hat{x} + j\hat{y}) \left(e^{-j4\pi z/3} - \frac{1}{5}e^{+j4\pi z/3} \right) \text{ V/m}$$

(d) Percentages of incident average power reflected and transmitted.

From *POWER REFLECTION* snippet, same formulas as P1:

$$\%P_r = 100|\Gamma|^2 = 100 \cdot \left| -\frac{1}{5} \right|^2 = 100 \cdot \frac{1}{25} = \boxed{4\%}$$

$$\%P_t = 100|\tau|^2 \frac{\eta_1}{\eta_2} = 100 \cdot \left| \frac{4}{5} \right|^2 \cdot \frac{120\pi}{80\pi} = 100 \cdot \frac{16}{25} \cdot \frac{3}{2} = \boxed{96\%}$$

Sanity check: $4\% + 96\% = 100\%$. Less reflection than P1 (4% vs 11.1%) because medium 2 is closer in impedance to air ($\eta_2 = 80\pi$ vs 60π); the smaller impedance jump means more of the wave gets through.

Problem 3 — Parallel-Polarized Wave Through Two Dielectric Layers 10 pts

Setup: $\theta_i = 30^\circ$ from air, layer 1 ($\epsilon_r = 6.25$, $t = 5$ cm), layer 2 ($\epsilon_r = 2.25$, $t = 5$ cm), exits to air.

SNELL'S LAW — OBLIQUE INCIDENCE

Single boundary *angles from normal*

$$\sin \theta_2 = \sin \theta_1 \sqrt{\frac{\epsilon_{r1}}{\epsilon_{r2}}} = \sin \theta_1 \frac{n_1}{n_2}$$

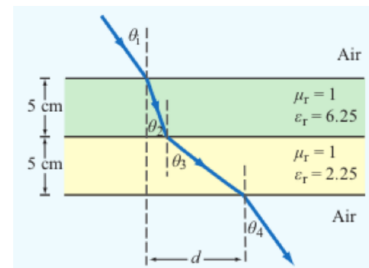
Multilayer chain *stack of slabs 1 $\rightarrow$ 2 $\rightarrow$ 3 $\rightarrow$ 4*

$$\sin \theta_{i+1} = \sin \theta_i \sqrt{\frac{\epsilon_{r,i}}{\epsilon_{r,i+1}}}$$

Air–slabs–air shortcut *outer media identical*

$$\theta_{\text{exit}} = \theta_{\text{incident}}$$

Snell only sets angles. Reflection/transmission magnitudes need Fresnel coefficients (parallel vs perpendicular).

LATERAL DISPLACEMENT

Beam offset through N slabs *thickness t_i , refracted angle inside slab i*

Slab-indexed $\theta_i = \text{angle inside slab } i$

$$d = \sum_{i=1}^N t_i \tan \theta_i$$

Angle-indexed (HW3 P3 style) $\theta_1 = \text{incident}, \theta_{i+1} = \text{inside slab } i$

$$d = \sum_{i=1}^N t_i \tan \theta_{i+1}$$

Same physics, different numbering. In HW3 P3: slab 1 contributes $t_1 \tan \theta_2$, slab 2 contributes $t_2 \tan \theta_3$. The angle in the formula is always the one the ray makes inside that slab.

Air–slab–air: exit angle returns to θ_1 but is laterally shifted by d .

(a) Chained Snell's law:

$$\sin \theta_2 = \sin 30^\circ \sqrt{\frac{1}{6.25}} = 0.5 \cdot 0.4 = 0.2 \Rightarrow \theta_2 = \sin^{-1}(0.2) = \boxed{11.54^\circ}$$

$$\sin \theta_3 = 0.2 \sqrt{\frac{6.25}{2.25}} = 0.2 \cdot \frac{5}{3} = \frac{1}{3} \Rightarrow \theta_3 = \sin^{-1}(1/3) = \boxed{19.47^\circ}$$

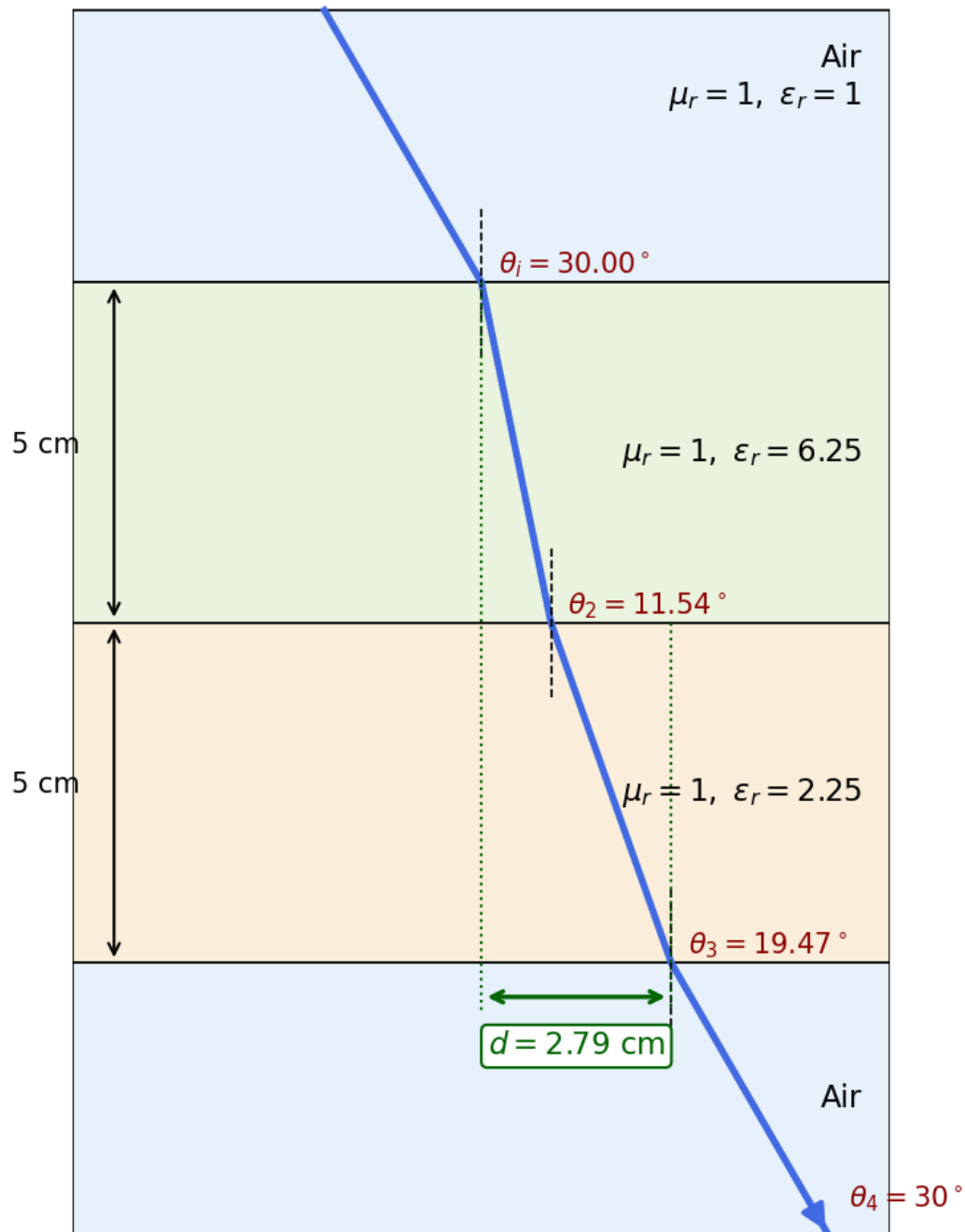
$$\sin \theta_4 = \frac{1}{3} \sqrt{\frac{2.25}{1}} = \frac{1}{3} \cdot \frac{3}{2} = \frac{1}{2} \Rightarrow \theta_4 = \boxed{30^\circ = \theta_i}$$

(b) Lateral displacement:

$$d = t_1 \tan \theta_2 + t_2 \tan \theta_3 = 5 \tan 11.54^\circ + 5 \tan 19.47^\circ = 5(0.2041 + 0.3536) \text{ cm}$$

$$\boxed{d = 2.79 \text{ cm}}$$

HW3 P3: parallel-polarized wave through dielectric layers



Problem 4 — Dielectric Waveguide TE Mode Identification

20 pts

Setup: TE wave, $a = 5$ cm, $b = 3$ cm, $E_x = -36 \cos(40\pi x) \sin(100\pi y) \sin((2.4\pi \times 10^{10})t - 52.9\pi z)$ V/m.

RECTANGULAR WAVEGUIDE — MODES

TE mode $E_z = 0, H_z \neq 0$

TM mode $H_z = 0, E_z \neq 0$

Dimensions $a \times b$ with $a > b$ along $\hat{x}, \hat{y}$; wave in $\hat{z}$.

E_x form (TE) read m, n from arguments

$$E_x \propto \cos\left(\frac{m\pi x}{a}\right) \sin\left(\frac{n\pi y}{b}\right) \sin(\omega t - \beta z)$$

coef. on $x = m\pi/a$; coef. on $y = n\pi/b$.

Identify TE_{mn} vs TM_{mn} cos/sin pattern of E_x is identical for both!

1. Read the problem statement (e.g. “a TE wave” $\rightarrow$ TE).
2. If $m = 0$ or $n = 0$ in the mode label $\Rightarrow$ must be TE (TM forbids 0).
3. Source field $H_z(x, y)$ given $\Rightarrow$ TE. Source field $E_z(x, y)$ given $\Rightarrow$ TM.

TE allows at least one of $m, n \geq 1$ (other can be 0). TM needs both $m, n \geq 1$. That's why TE_{10} exists but TM_{10} doesn't.

 ϵ_r FROM DISPERSION

Given ω, β , mode (m, n)

$$\epsilon_r = \frac{c^2}{\omega^2} \left[\beta^2 + \left(\frac{m\pi}{a}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{n\pi}{b}\right)^2 \right]$$

Sanity: β in rad/m, a, b in m, ω in rad/s.

CUTOFF FREQUENCY

f_{mn} m, n integers ≥ 0 (not both zero)

$$f_{mn} = \frac{u_{p0}}{2} \sqrt{\left(\frac{m}{a}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{n}{b}\right)^2} \text{ (Hz)}$$

Common cutoffs ($a > b$)

Quantity	Formula
u_{p0}	$c/\sqrt{\epsilon_r}$ (hollow: $u_{p0} = c$)
TE_{10}	$u_{p0}/(2a)$ (dominant)
TE_{01}	$u_{p0}/(2b)$
TE_{20}	$u_{p0}/a = 2f_{10}$
$\text{TE}_{11}, \text{TM}_{11}$	$\frac{u_{p0}}{2} \sqrt{1/a^2 + 1/b^2}$

Propagation requires $f > f_{mn}$.

WAVE IMPEDANCE & H_y

$$Z_{\text{TE}} = \frac{\eta}{\sqrt{1 - (f_c/f)^2}} \text{ (}\Omega\text{)} \quad Z_{\text{TM}} = \eta \sqrt{1 - (f_c/f)^2}$$

$$\eta = \frac{\eta_0}{\sqrt{\epsilon_r}} \quad H_y = \frac{E_x}{Z_{\text{TE}}} \text{ (TE mode)}$$

$Z_{\text{TE}} > \eta$ always (denominator < 1); $Z_{\text{TM}} < \eta$.

(a) **Mode from the field expression.** Read $m\pi/a$ from the cos coefficient and $n\pi/b$ from the sin coefficient.

$$\frac{m\pi}{a} = 40\pi \Rightarrow m = 40 \cdot 0.05 = 2$$

$$\frac{n\pi}{b} = 100\pi \Rightarrow n = 100 \cdot 0.03 = 3$$

Mode: TE_{23}

(b) ϵ_r from dispersion, with $\omega = 2.4\pi \times 10^{10}$ rad/s, $\beta = 52.9\pi$ rad/m:

$$\epsilon_r = \frac{c^2}{\omega^2} \left[\beta^2 + \left(\frac{m\pi}{a}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{n\pi}{b}\right)^2 \right] = \left(\frac{3 \times 10^8}{2.4\pi \times 10^{10}} \right)^2 [(52.9\pi)^2 + (40\pi)^2 + (100\pi)^2]$$

$$\epsilon_r = 2.25$$

(c) Cutoff frequency for TE_{23} :

$$u_{p0} = \frac{c}{\sqrt{\epsilon_r}} = \frac{3 \times 10^8}{1.5} = 2 \times 10^8 \text{ m/s}$$

$$f_{23} = \frac{u_{p0}}{2} \sqrt{\left(\frac{2}{a}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{3}{b}\right)^2} = 10^8 \sqrt{(2/0.05)^2 + (3/0.03)^2} = 10^8 \sqrt{1600 + 10000}$$

$$f_{23} = 10.77 \text{ GHz}$$

(d) H_y from Z_{TE} : operating frequency $f = \omega/(2\pi) = 12 \text{ GHz}$.

$$Z_{\text{TE}} = \frac{\eta}{\sqrt{1-(f_c/f)^2}} = \frac{377/\sqrt{2.25}}{\sqrt{1-(10.77/12)^2}} = \frac{251.3}{\sqrt{1-0.805}} = \frac{251.3}{0.442} = 569.9 \text{ } \Omega$$

$$H_y = \frac{E_x}{Z_{\text{TE}}} = -0.063 \cos(40\pi x) \sin(100\pi y) \sin((2.4\pi \times 10^{10})t - 52.9\pi z) \text{ A/m}$$

Problem 5 — Hollow Guide, Multi-Mode Excitation & Travel Times 8 pts

Setup: Hollow guide ($\epsilon_r = 1$, $u_{p0} = c$), $a = 3$ cm, $b = 2$ cm. Pulse with 9.5 GHz carrier, guide length 100 m.

CUTOFF FREQUENCY

f_{mn} m, n integers ≥ 0 (not both zero)

$$f_{mn} = \frac{u_{p0}}{2} \sqrt{\left(\frac{m}{a}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{n}{b}\right)^2} \text{ (Hz)}$$

Common cutoffs ($a > b$)

Quantity	Formula
u_{p0}	$c/\sqrt{\epsilon_r}$ (hollow: $u_{p0} = c$)
TE ₁₀	$u_{p0}/(2a)$ (dominant)
TE ₀₁	$u_{p0}/(2b)$
TE ₂₀	$u_{p0}/a = 2f_{10}$
TE ₁₁ , TM ₁₁	$\frac{u_{p0}}{2} \sqrt{1/a^2 + 1/b^2}$

Propagation requires $f > f_{mn}$.

GROUP VELOCITY & TRAVEL TIME

$$u_g = u_{p0} \sqrt{1 - (f_{mn}/f)^2} \text{ (m/s)}$$

$$u_p = \frac{u_{p0}}{\sqrt{1 - (f_{mn}/f)^2}} \text{ (m/s)} \Rightarrow u_p u_g = u_{p0}^2 \text{ (m}^2\text{/s}^2\text{)}$$

$t = L/u_g$ (s) travel time through guide of length L
Higher modes have lower $u_g \Rightarrow$ they arrive later. Group delay spread = sum over excited modes.

Cutoff frequencies for the lowest modes:

$$f_{10} = \frac{c}{2a} = \frac{3 \times 10^8}{0.06} = 5 \text{ GHz}$$

$$f_{01} = \frac{c}{2b} = \frac{3 \times 10^8}{0.04} = 7.5 \text{ GHz}$$

$$f_{11} = \frac{c}{2} \sqrt{\frac{1}{a^2} + \frac{1}{b^2}} = (1.5 \times 10^8) \sqrt{(1/0.03)^2 + (1/0.02)^2} = 9.01 \text{ GHz}$$

$$f_{20} = \frac{c}{a} = 10 \text{ GHz} \quad (> 9.5, \text{ not excited})$$

Modes excited (carrier $\hat{u}$ f_c): TE₁₀, TE₀₁, TE₁₁, TM₁₁. TE₂₀ is just above cutoff so it does not propagate.

Group velocities: $u_g = c\sqrt{1 - (f_{mn}/f)^2}$ with $f = 9.5$ GHz.

Mode	f_c (GHz)	u_g/c	u_g (m/s)
TE ₁₀	5.00	$\sqrt{1 - (5/9.5)^2} = 0.85$	2.55×10^8
TE ₀₁	7.50	$\sqrt{1 - (7.5/9.5)^2} = 0.61$	1.84×10^8
TE ₁₁ , TM ₁₁	9.01	$\sqrt{1 - (9.01/9.5)^2} = 0.32$	0.95×10^8

Travel times: $t = L/u_g$ over 100 m.

Mode	t (μ s)
TE ₁₀	0.39
TE ₀₁	0.54
TE ₁₁ , TM ₁₁	1.05

Higher modes arrive later because they propagate closer to cutoff, so u_g drops.